

Rahaf Abutarbush

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SUMMARY

Innovative leader with a proven track record in building and scaling technology labs and crafting innovation strategies for government entities. Currently heads PwC Middle East's Emerging Technology Lab in Qatar, driving technology innovation across the region. Skilled in converting emerging technologies into practical products and strategic initiatives.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

PwC Middle East, Emerging Tech Innovation lead & Qatar Lab Lead 05/2022 – present

- Lead PwC Middle East's Emerging Technology Lab in Qatar, defining its strategic vision, innovation portfolio, and roadmap across AI, XR, robotics, and other emerging technologies in response to government and enterprise needs across the GCC.
- Built and scaled Qatar's Emerging Technology Lab from the ground up, establishing its operating model and growing it into a regional innovation function spanning PwC's MENA labs; promoted twice in three years from Associate to Manager.
- Founded and led the Lab's AI capability, establishing its first structured AI product function and building a cross-functional team responsible for use-case identification, experimentation, prototyping, evaluation, and product development.
- Established a rapid experimentation and product-development pipeline, product-managing 30+ AI prototypes from opportunity identification and use-case definition through build, testing, iteration, and validation for real-world deployment.
- Introduced monetizable emerging-technology use cases and a Labs-as-a-Service model for government and enterprise clients.
- Led a multi-million-dollar government innovation lab opportunity from ideation through contract award, defining the innovation portfolio, AI use cases, operating model, and product vision in alignment with Qatar's National Development Strategy.
- Generated \$73M+ in revenue by identifying and developing high-value AI opportunities with government clients across the GCC, translating emerging technology trends into funded initiatives and real-world applications.
- Act as a senior innovation advisor to CEOs, ministers, and government leaders, leading 90+ workshops, strategy sessions, and executive presentations for 1,000+ stakeholders and translating complex technology trends into actionable innovation priorities.
- Built strategic relationships across Qatar and the GCC technology ecosystem, collaborating with government entities, global technology companies, academic institutions, and innovation partners to advance emerging-technology initiatives.
- Developed and tested emerging-technology applications across AI, XR, computer vision, and digital experiences to rapidly move concepts from research into functional prototypes.

RK Techhub, Founder 12/2021 – present

- Built an AI-native product development practice focused on rapidly turning concepts into functional digital products.
- Designed and deployed web applications using React, Vite, Supabase, and Vercel, leveraging AI development tools including Claude Code, Cursor, and Lovable.
- Built a custom multi-agent AI development pipeline that orchestrates specialist agents across architecture, design, development, and QA to automate the web application development lifecycle.
- Developed client dashboards, progress tracking systems, and reusable UI systems that translate product concepts into digital experiences.

QCapsule Industries, Co-founder 04/2025 – Present

- Conceptualized and designed QCapsule, a modular smart living infrastructure targeting hospitality, government, and remote environments across the GCC
- Led the venture's strategy end-to-end, from concept and physical prototype through market positioning and GTM exploration
- Defined applications across tourism, government, and off-grid operations, translating market needs into product concepts and deployment scenarios.
- Developed product visuals, videos, architectural floor plans, and marketing assets using AI-enabled creative tools and developed the initial GTM strategy.

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University, BSC. in Information Systems

09/2018 – 05/2022

- Minor: Business Administration, concentration in Human-computer Interaction & User Experience
 - Honors: Senior Leadership Award, Dean's list 2021
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KEY PROJECTS

- AI Concierge System (Hospitality Pilot): Designed and product-managed a conversational AI concierge with 7Rooms integration, Arabic voice interface, and operator dashboard; scoped use cases, defined performance requirements, and oversaw build
- CityOS (Smart City Platform): Product-managed a cross-sector data aggregation platform for GCC smart city infrastructure, addressing fragmentation across transport, infrastructure, and government services
- National Innovation Lab (Confidential): Contributed to winning and delivering a national initiative, building prototypes aligned with Qatar National Development Strategy
- Daclimb (Productivity Platform): Built an end-to-end productivity dashboard for neurodivergent users using vibe coding tools, focusing on structured UX and real-world usability

Thought leadership reports

- A playbook for building national innovation programmes(Turning labs into innovation engines) - 2026
 - Emerging Technologies in the Middle East - 2025
 - Emerging tech in Qatar Banking report -2024
 - Metaverse Assembly outcomes Report with Dubai Future Foundation - 2022
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SKILLS & ENGAGEMENTS

Global & Regional Events and ecosystem engagement

- Delivered keynote at Web Summit Qatar 2026 and represented PwC across major regional and global technology forums.
- Speaker at Georgetown University and Carnegie Mellon University in Qatar on AI, emerging technologies, and applied innovation
- Featured panelist across Microsoft Women in Tech initiatives, Web Summit Qatar, LEAP, World AI Summit, and Metaverse & AI Assembly.
- Recognized in international media, including Euronews and WIRED, for contributions to emerging technology and innovation
- Contributed to ecosystem-level initiatives tied to national technology infrastructure, including the Microsoft Data Center Launch in Qatar and Google Cloud Summit in Qatar
- Actively engaged across Middle East and European innovation ecosystems through participation in international forums (e.g., DEALS 2023, Spain) and cross-market collaboration
- Career coach to 4 team members, guiding their development and helping them fast-track growth and performance.
- Designed and led emerging technology workshops for students aged 9–16, fostering early interest in innovation and tech.
- Mentored early-stage builders at hackathons (e.g., Lifelines), supporting development of AI-enabled and crisis-response solutions
- Judge at Carnegie Mellon's Tech Startup Launchpad 2022-2026
- Judge at Alice Programming competitions
- Panels and talks on life from university to industry

Technical Skills

AI & Emerging Technology: LLM Applications, AI Use-Case Scoping & Evaluation, Prompt Engineering, Multi-Agent Systems, Computer Vision, XR

Product & Innovation: Product Strategy, Innovation Roadmapping, Rapid Prototyping, Innovation Strategy, Human-Centered Design, Miro, Figma

Development: Python, React, Vite, Supabase, SQL, OpenCV

AI Product Tools: Claude Code, Cursor, Lovable, Higgsfield, Canva

Languages: Arabic (Native), English (Fluent)

Extracurriculars & Leadership Roles

- Captain of Carnegie Mellon Arabic Debate Team
- President & Executive Producer of TEDxCMUQ
- Outreach director of the Information Systems Association
- President of the Carnegie Consulting Club